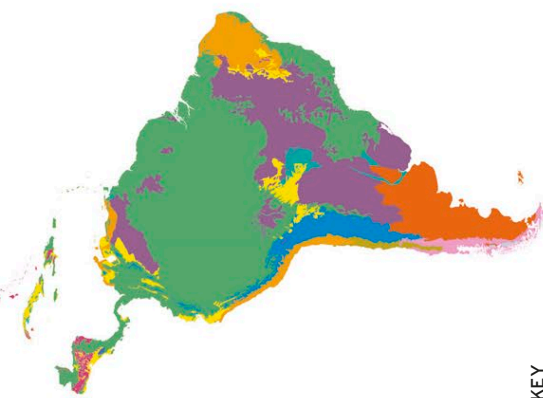




ECOSYSTEMS

South America's center is dominated by the Amazon rain forest with its huge diversity of life. The Andes have unique mountain ecosystems, while the south of the continent is mostly dry grassland.



KEY

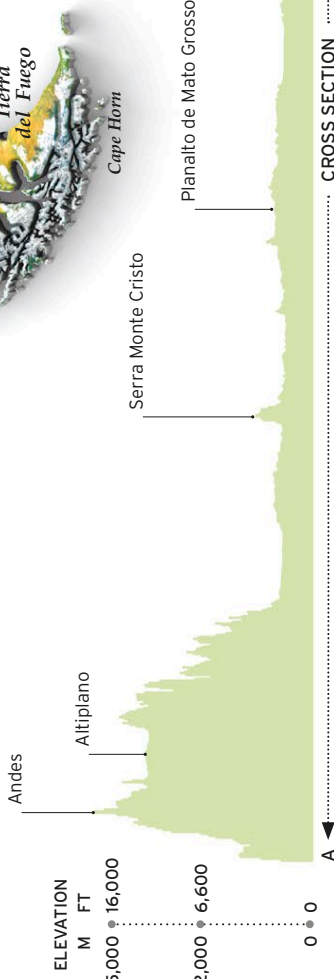
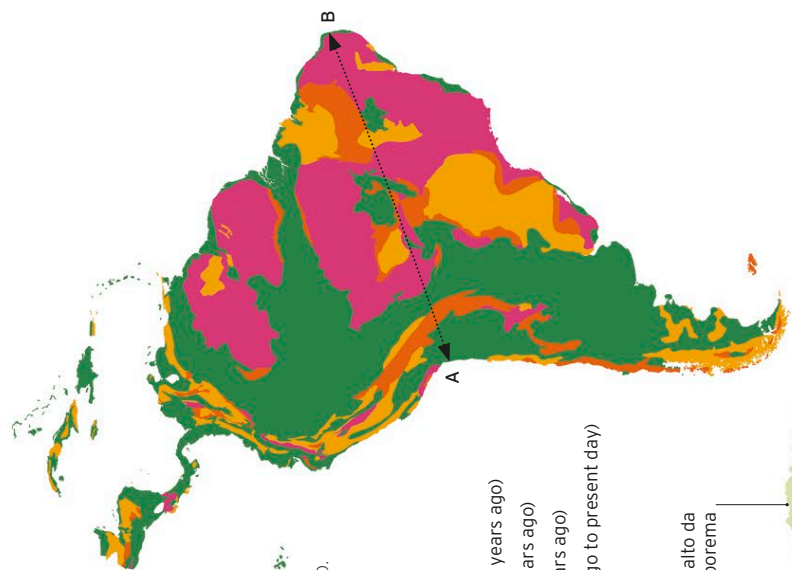
- Tropical broadleaf forest
- Tropical dry broadleaf forest
- Tropical coniferous forest
- Temperate broadleaf forest
- Mediterranean woodland and scrub
- Tropical and subtropical grassland
- Temperate grassland
- Wetland
- Montane grassland
- Desert and scrub

GEOLOGY

South America's core, the high tablelands of the northeast, is made of ancient rocks. The Andes are comparatively young, forming 50 million years ago. Between the tablelands and the Andes is a series of young river basins.

KEY

- Precambrian (pre-541 million years ago)
- Paleozoic (541-252 million years ago)
- Mesozoic (252-66 million years ago)
- Cenozoic (66 million years ago to present day)



CROSS SECTION